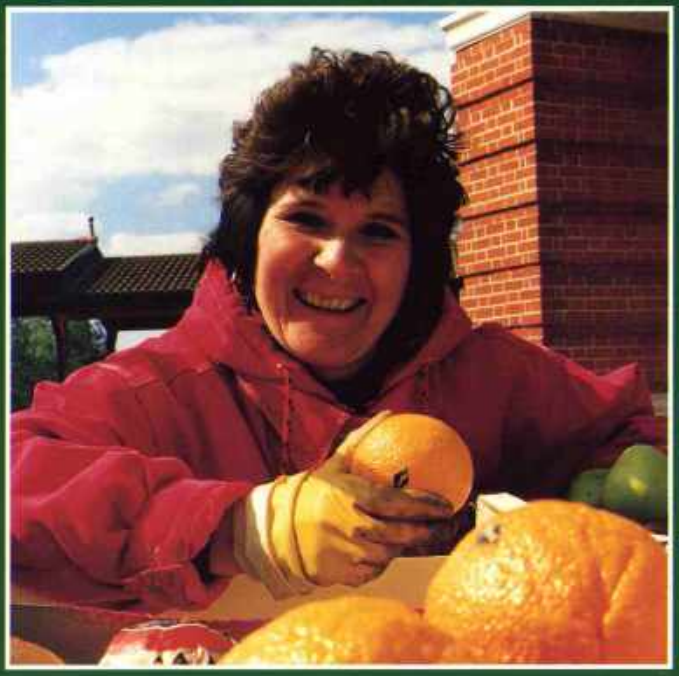
REPORT TO RESIDENTS









Thamesmead

The Thamesmead year 1996/1997

We spent a record total of
on maintaining, managing and improving Tha

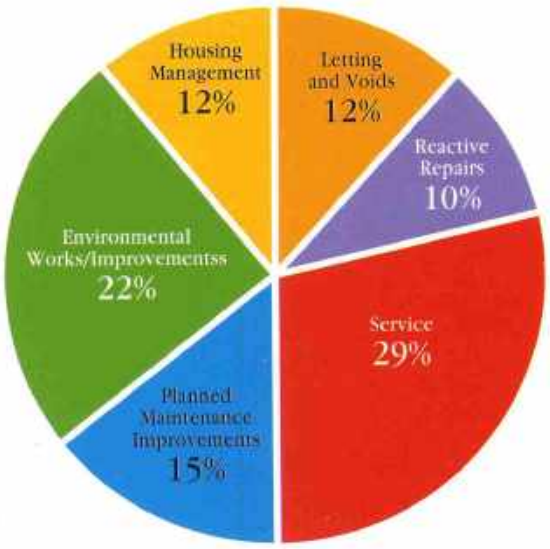
Although we froze assured rents for the second year and limited the increase in fair rents to 3.7%, we spent a record total of £15.6 million on maintaining, managing and improving Thamesmead's 4674 homes.



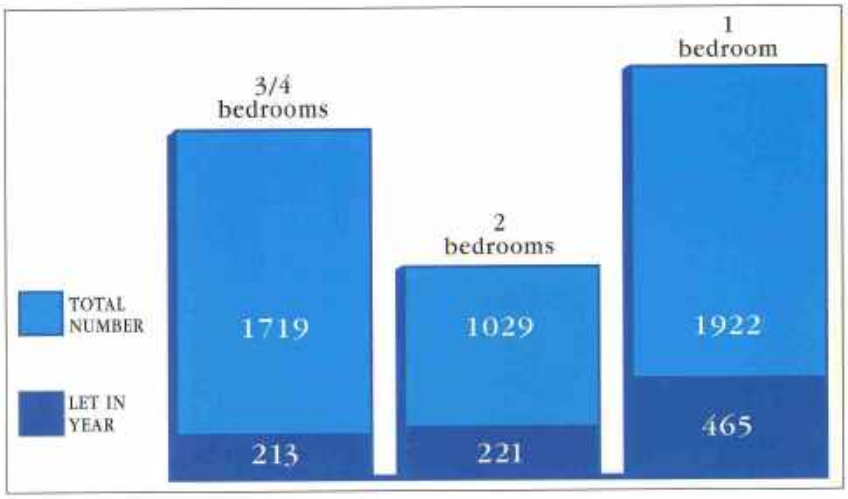
Tony Cotter, Housing Services Director, reports

The Housing Department manages and maintains over 6000 homes in Thamesmead, 4674 rented, the remaining for service charge payers.

HOW YOUR RENT AND SERVICE CHARGES WERE SPENT

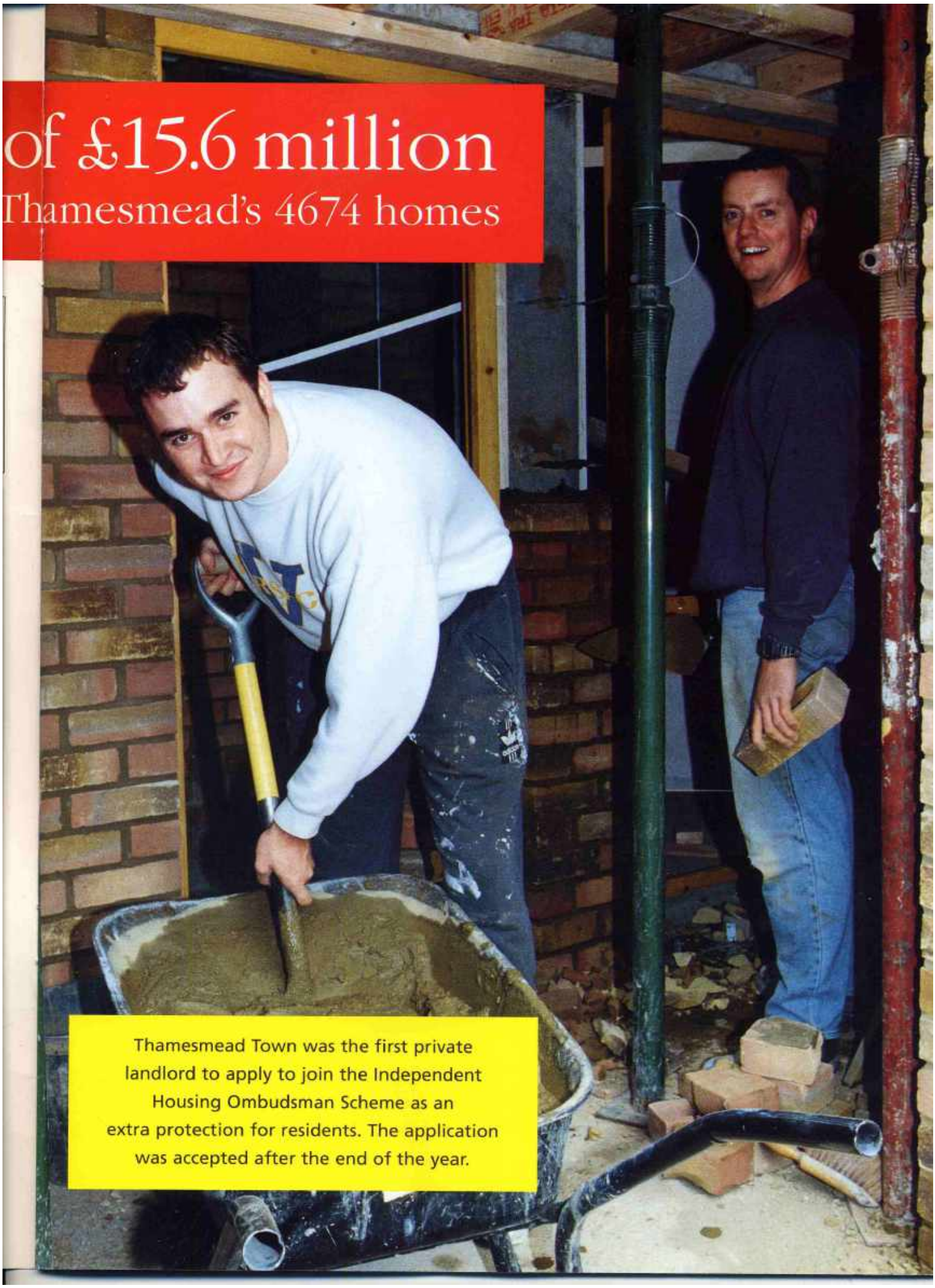


899 homes were let during the year



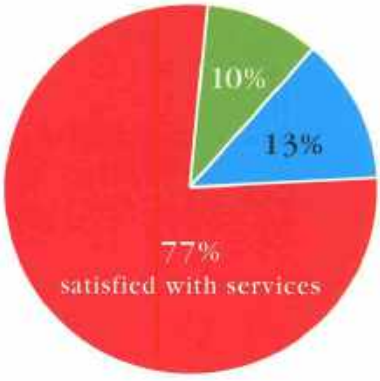


of £15.6 million
Thamesmead's 4674 homes



Thamesmead Town was the first private landlord to apply to join the Independent Housing Ombudsman Scheme as an extra protection for residents. The application was accepted after the end of the year.





The survey of residents receiving housing services from Thamesmead found:

- 77% were satisfied with our services - a figure 15% higher than the national average
- 10% said there was room for improvement
- 13% had no opinion

of residents satisfied with services
(national average only 62%)

During 1996 we carried a Residents Satisfaction Survey using independent opinion survey organisation Dome Consultants. The results are enabling us to respond by further improving our service and Thamesmead as a whole.

We continued our programme of upgrading and improvement throughout the year. Brand new bedroom windows, which reduce heat loss and cut down noise, were installed in 160 homes in Coralline Walk. Security improvements included new door entry systems for all the blocks in Waterfield, The Moorings and Wren Path. The entry systems in Crossway and Manorway were improved, allowing the front door to be operated from inside the flats.

Other improvements included new kitchens for the older residents of Shire Court.







SATISFIED WITH REPAIR SERVICE	82%
HAPPY WITH WAY HOMES LEFT AFTER REPAIR	91%
SATISFIED WITH HOUSING ADVICE	81%

The survey confirmed that people like living in Thamesmead. Almost 75% of those interviewed said they didn't intend to move home within the next five years - and a quarter of those who planned to move wanted to stay in the town.

We spent £320,
fitness and





Development of the community and the environment is vital for the future of Thamesmead.

Julian Martin, Director of Economic and Community Regeneration, and David Foreman, Urban Regeneration Manager, report



The most-requested improvement highlighted in our survey was more facilities for young people.

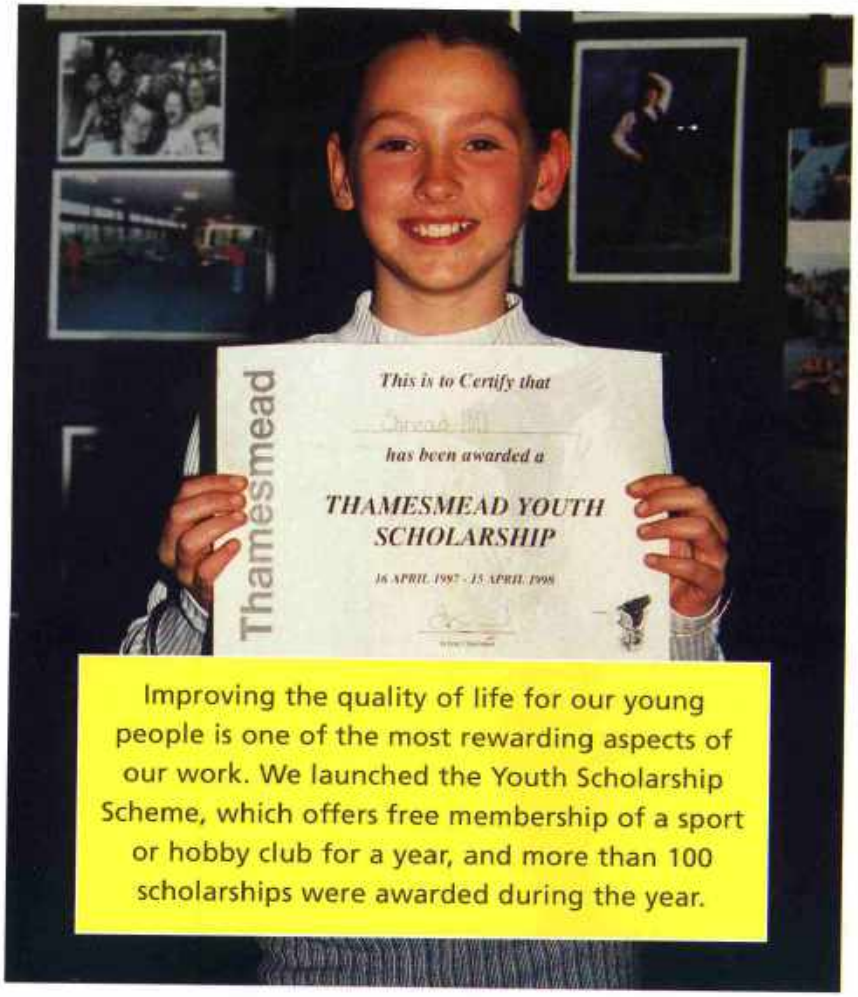
27%	27% ASKED FOR MORE FACILITIES FOR THE YOUNG
5%	5% ASKED FOR MORE LEISURE FACILITIES
5%	5% ASKED FOR MORE COMMUNAL AREA IMPROVEMENTS



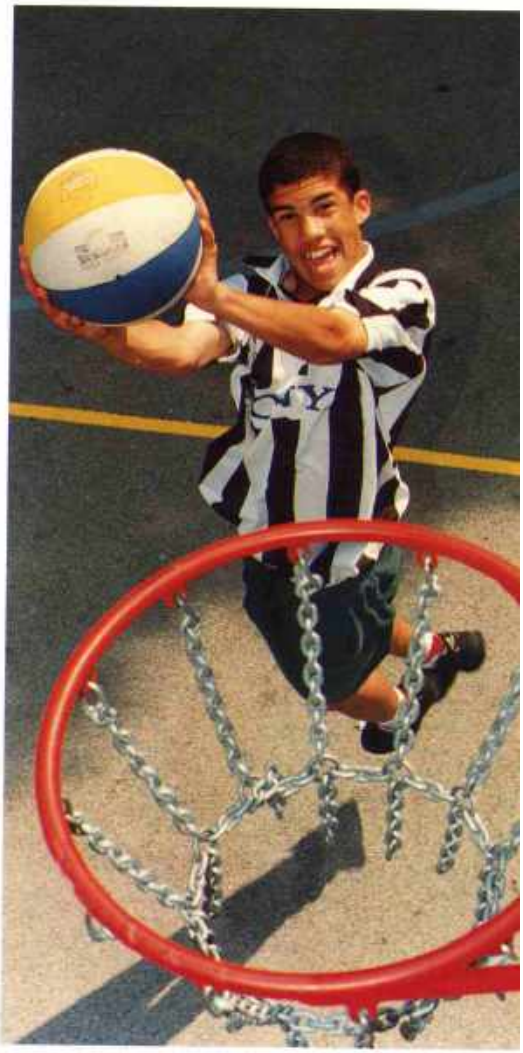
The first section of the Thames Cycle Route has been opened along the river in the eastern part of the town; it's made from recycled material using locally reclaimed crushed concrete. The route will eventually run from Dartford to Hampton Court.

0,000 on sports
nd play areas

Titmuss Avenue Sports and Fitness Area	£65,000
Abbey Way Play Area	£46,000
St John Fisher Play Area	£40,000
Tavy Pools Play Area Phase 1	£65,000
Other projects	£104,000



Improving the quality of life for our young people is one of the most rewarding aspects of our work. We launched the Youth Scholarship Scheme, which offers free membership of a sport or hobby club for a year, and more than 100 scholarships were awarded during the year.



We spent £320,000 on sports, fitness and play areas building five significant new play areas and upgrading 'kickabout' areas with basketball and/or football goals.

£500,000 was spent on community a
£642,000 on environmental improve

Thamesmead has a community facility for every 780 residents, compared with one per 2300 in Greenwich and Bexley boroughs.

Regular constituency meetings, which help to get as many residents as possible involved in decision making, were continued as part of our policy of consultation. The meetings have been warmly welcomed, with up to 50 people attending each one.



As part of our application for extra funds from the Single Regeneration Budget (SRB), a community audit was carried out by an independent research company. The audit involved community groups and organisations to give us a picture of the strengths we should build on and the weaknesses we must tackle in order to plan for the sort of future our residents want.





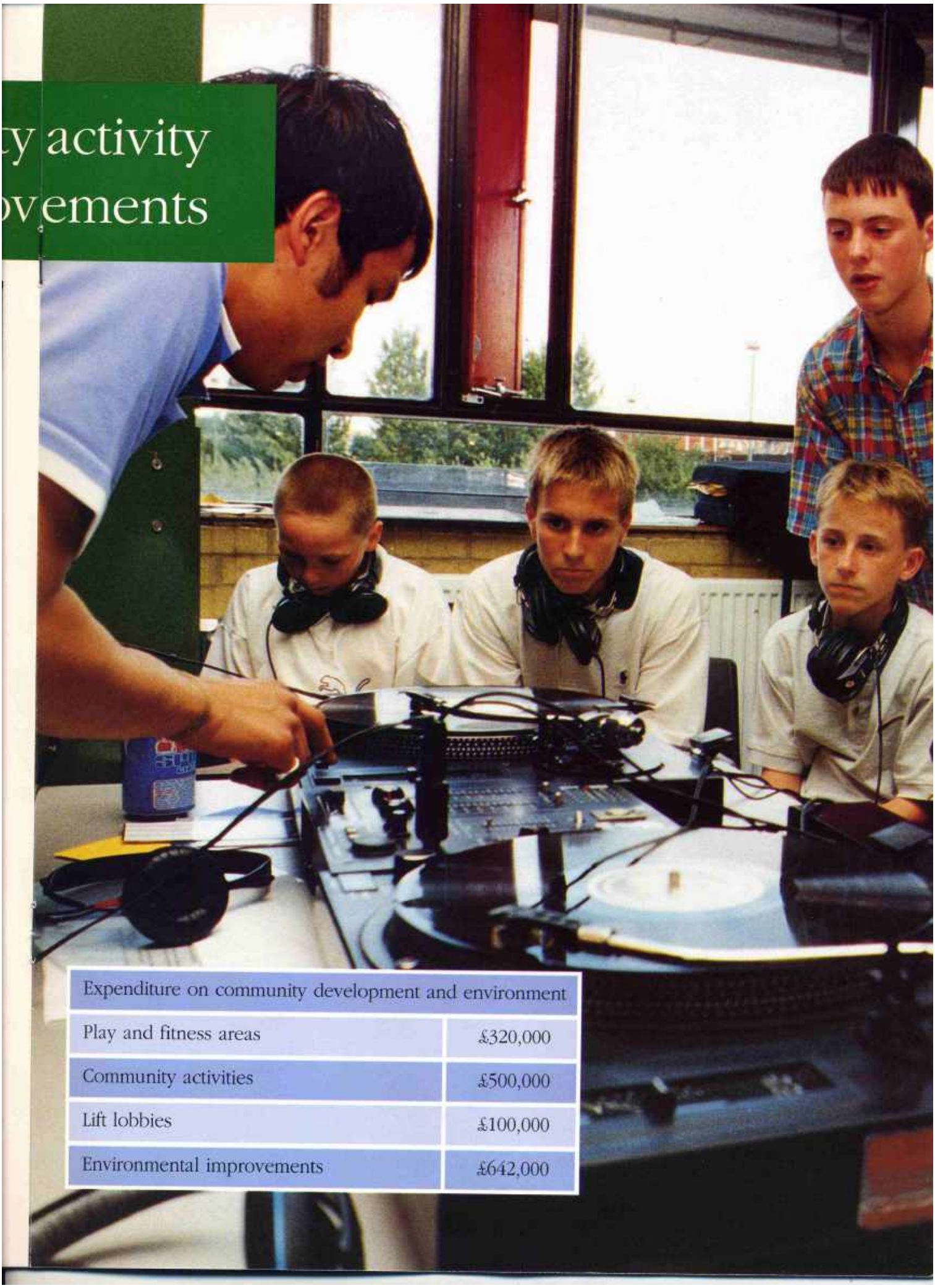
The garages in Coralline Walk were improved, with new lighting and a clever "wave effect" paint scheme



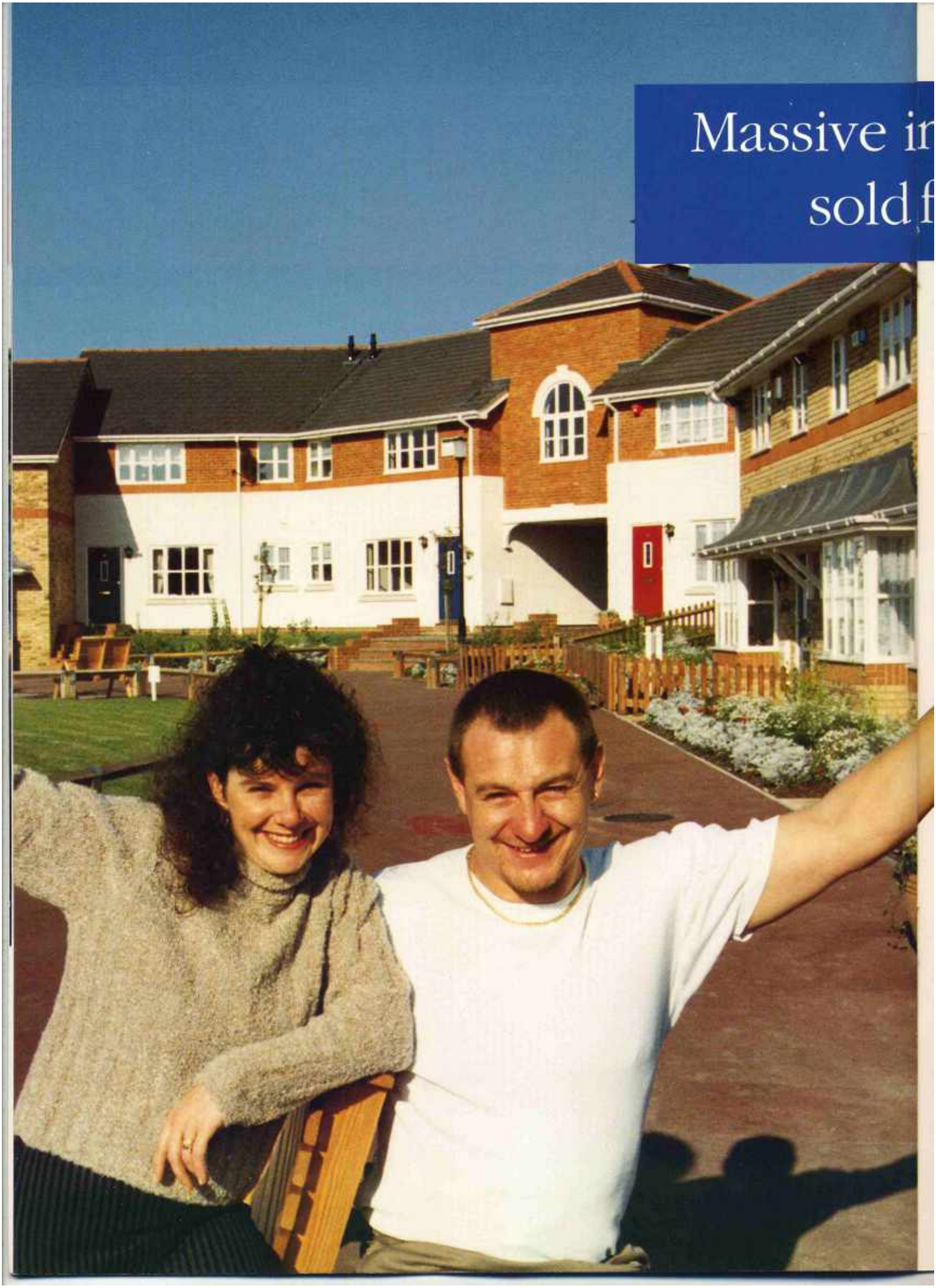
Residents in Tavy Bridge took part in a community planning week-end, which gave them the authority to help in developing plans for creating a better local environment.

Initiatives for our young people included a drugs education programme for schools, support for the opening of Hawksmoor Youth Club on Sundays, and the Roving Play Scheme which started in the summer. Over 2000 young people participated in the scheme.

ty activity
ovements



Expenditure on community development and environment	
Play and fitness areas	£320,000
Community activities	£500,000
Lift lobbies	£100,000
Environmental improvements	£642,000

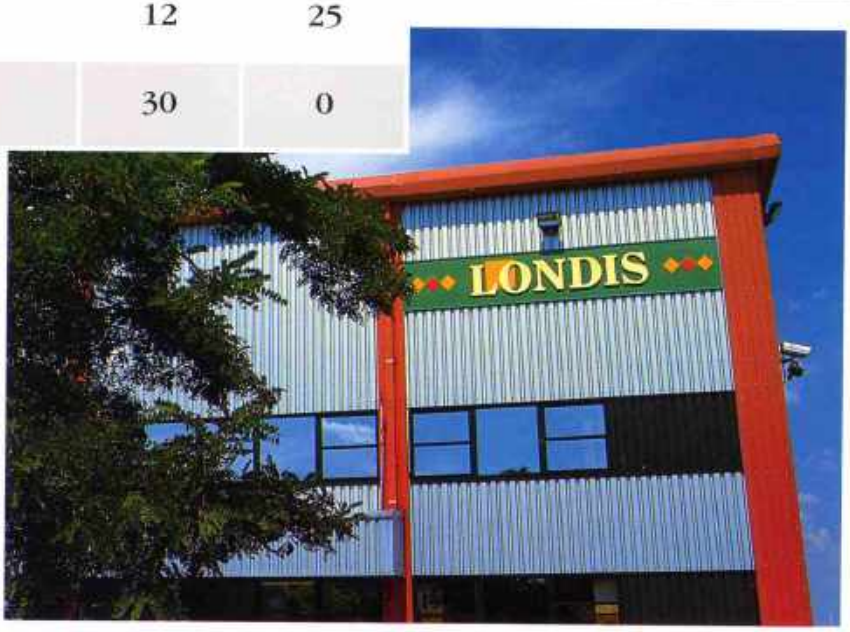

Massive in
sold f

e increase in new building - 16.5 acres
ld for development

	1995/6	1996/7
Residential land sales	1.9 acres	9.5 acres
Commercial land sales	0.5 acres	7.0 acres
New homes completed and sold to the public	55	116
New homes bought by Thamesmead	12	25
Housing Assn. completions	30	0




Residential, commercial and industrial growth underpins the success of Thamesmead. Willie Bossert, Director of Development, and David Novi, Commercial Estates Manager, report.



141 homes were built by Barratt at Birchmere View and Voyagers Quay, and were amongst the company's fastest-selling developments in the South East. Work was started by Wilcon on over 600 homes on a riverside site.

And Hexagon Housing Association is building 39 homes at Gallions Lake.

A new nursing home at Copperfield Road is expected to provide up to 80 jobs.



COMMERCIAL ESTATES PERFORMANCE

- RENT ROLL UP 4.2%
- PROPERTY ENQUIRIES UP 4.2%
- EMPTY UNIT WORKSHOPS DOWN ALMOST 30%
- RENT ARREARS DOWN 25%

Thamesmead businesses poised
New business opportunities in London's



A business audit carried out during the year showed encouraging progress not only for job prospects but also 81 Thamesmead businesses reported that they were planning to expand within the town (70% response to the survey).

Keeping the right balance between building new homes, establishing new social and leisure facilities, and creating new job opportunities is essential for the future of Thamesmead. The proposed Gallions Reach Urban Village points the way to the future, with a lifestyle mix of around 1500 homes plus local shops and commercial buildings. The development will add to Thamesmead's growing popularity as a major business location, and our partners in creating it include Barratt, Beazer, English Partnerships, Fairclough and Persimmon.



More than 200 businesses already operate in the town, and play a vital role in its success. Hi-Lo Manufacturing, for example, trains young people over a four year period, under a Modern Apprentice scheme set up with the help of SOLOTEC: apprentices gain practical experience and an academic qualification. Hi-Lo, based in Nathan Way, have also set up the non-profit-making Triangle nursery to help working parents.

And the town is the birthplace of the 180kph Cumberland sausage! Ferndale Foods, who employ around 400 people in their Hailey Road operation, supply the sausages for the dining cars on Eurostar trains.

During the year we continued our policy of upgrading and improving the environment at



our business parks in co-operation with development agencies, and made substantial investments in security improvements.

Job prospects were boosted by a business audit.

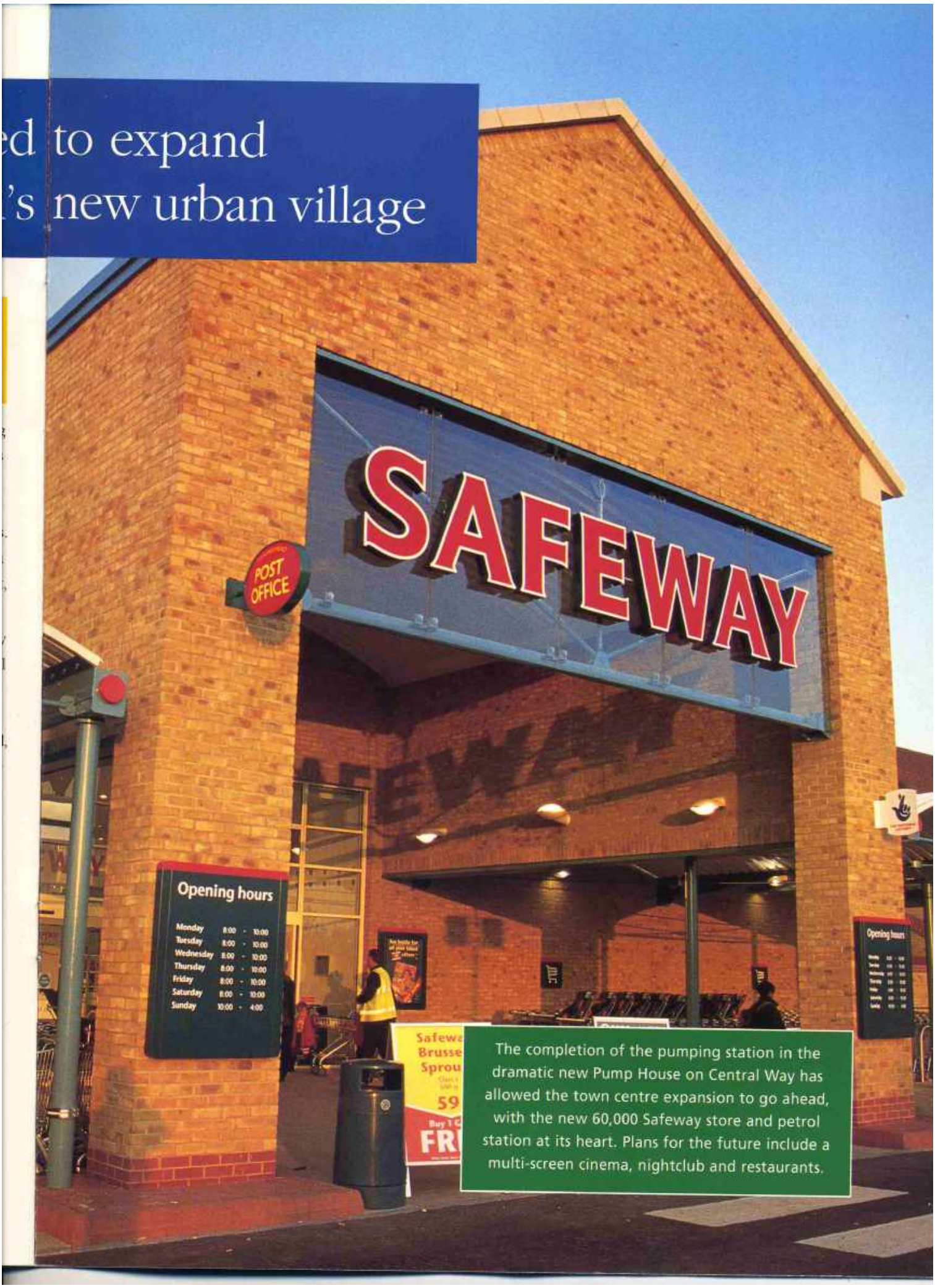
144

businesses responded.

81

said they were planning to expand in Thamesmead which means new jobs for you.

ed to expand
's new urban village



The completion of the pumping station in the dramatic new Pump House on Central Way has allowed the town centre expansion to go ahead, with the new 60,000 Safeway store and petrol station at its heart. Plans for the future include a multi-screen cinema, nightclub and restaurants.

"To maximise the potential of the community and resources while improving the contentment of people living and working in Thamesmead"

Mission statement by the Board of Thamesmead Town



Thamesmead

Where London is coming to life

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Tel: 0181 310 1500.